THE APPLIED INTELLIGENCE ACADEMY

APERTURE

SEMESTER I · SYLLABUS

Foundations of Human Behavior, Evidence & Executive Leadership

14 weeks · 5–7 hours a week · 60 lessons · 3 schools

School of Behavioral & Social Science
School of Business & Leadership
School of Law & Strategy

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AT A GLANCE

PROGRAM	APERTURE – The Applied Intelligence Academy
FORMAT	Self-paced, online; written lessons or narrated lectures, labs, cases, readings
WORKLOAD	5–7 hours a week; 98.6 planned hours in all
ASSESSMENT	Weekly quizzes 30% · Applied assignments 25% · Midterm 20% · Executive capstone 25%
MASTERY	80% on quizzes and the midterm, with focused review and reassessment below it
NARRATED LECTURES	5 released (Week 1 and Week 2, Lesson 1); 55 coming soon
ACCESS	cperez.app/apps/aperture · Syllabus page: Curriculum → Syllabus

1 Course Overview

Semester I, *Foundations of Human Behavior, Evidence & Executive Leadership*, is a 14-week program in how people judge, decide, learn, lead and negotiate, and how organizations turn evidence, strategy, finance and law into decisions. It moves from the individual (judgment, motivation, learning, evidence) to the social (leadership, power, negotiation) and the organizational (design, strategy, finance, law, execution, ethics), and ends in an executive capstone that uses all of it.

The course draws on 3 schools — School of Behavioral & Social Science, School of Business & Leadership, School of Law & Strategy — and on a research library of 197 verified sources. It is written for working professionals and asks for about 5–7 hours a week.

EDUCATIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Evidence, labelled
Every passage of every lesson says what it is — established research, a contested finding, APERTURE's own explanation, an illustrative example, a professional application or a speculative hypothesis — and research claims cite the library.

Mastery before momentum
Quizzes and the midterm set mastery at 80%. Below it, you get the lessons and concepts behind your misses and a reassessment drawn from reserve questions.

Retrieval and spacing
Comprehension checks after each lesson, 220 spaced-repetition review cards and weekly reflections turn reading into memory.

Calibration over confidence
Labs and assessments ask how sure you are, not only what you think, so the semester measures the match between confidence and accuracy.

Practice on realistic problems
Each week pairs an interactive lab with an original case (15 in all) and an applied assignment written as professional work.

Honest assessment
Objective items are auto-graded with the scoring rules shown on every results page. Written work is self-assessed against published rubrics and labelled as such; automated checks cover format only, never content.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

Each week's own objectives (75 in all) appear in the app's Syllabus page and on each week page. Across the semester they build toward nine objectives:

1. **Calibrated judgment** Wk 1, 4, 13
2. **Behavioral diagnosis** Wk 2, 3
3. **Evidence and causal reasoning** Wk 3, 4, 13
4. **Leadership and influence** Wk 5, 6
5. **Negotiation** Wk 7
6. **Organizational and strategic design** Wk 8, 9, 12
7. **Financial decision-making** Wk 10
8. **Legal and ethical reasoning** Wk 11, 13
9. **Executive communication and integration** Wk 5, 14

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

By the end of the semester you will have produced a working decision journal, fourteen pieces of applied professional work and a full executive capstone, and you will have a measured record of your calibration, mastery and progress. Section 10 lists the competencies the course is designed to build.

2 Academic Structure

THE FOURTEEN-WEEK SEMESTER

Each week is planned at 5–7 hours: about 3 hours of lessons (or lectures — watching replaces reading the same lesson), 1 hour of reading, and the lab, case, quiz, assignment and reflection. Optional readings are not counted.

WK	THEME	SCHOOL	LESSONS	HOURS
1	**How to Think**	Behavioral & Social Science	4	7
2	**Why People Behave the Way They Do**	Behavioral & Social Science	4	7
3	**How Humans Learn and Develop Expertise**	Behavioral & Social Science	4	7
4	**How to Know What Is True**	Behavioral & Social Science	5	7.5
5	**Leadership Is a Social System**	Business & Leadership	4	7
6	**Power, Politics & Organizational Influence**	Business & Leadership	4	6.9
7	**Negotiation & Bargaining** MIDTERM	Law & Strategy	5	7
8	**Building Effective Organizations**	Business & Leadership	4	7
9	**Business Strategy & Competitive Advantage**	Business & Leadership	4	7
10	**Finance for Executive Decision-Making**	Business & Leadership	5	7
11	**Law for Business Leaders**	Law & Strategy	5	7
12	**Strategy into Execution**	Business & Leadership	4	7
13	**Ethics, Governance and Decisions Under Uncertainty**	Law & Strategy	4	7.3
14	**The Executive Capstone** CAPSTONE	Business & Leadership	4	7
	Semester		**60**	**98.6**

The **School of Behavioral & Social Science** leads Weeks 1, 2, 3, 4; The **School of Business & Leadership** leads Weeks 5, 6, 8, 9, 10, 12, 14; The **School of Law & Strategy** leads Weeks 7, 11, 13. The schools are interleaved, and every week draws on the others.

INSTRUCTIONAL FORMATS

Written lessons
60 lessons (about 110,000 words), each in five parts — Explore, Understand, Challenge, Apply, Retain — with a source panel and a short comprehension check (131 questions in all).

Readings
Required and optional readings each week, 39 required and 68 optional across the semester, with a reason to read each one.

Cases
An original, clearly fictional case each week with discussion questions; write your position before reading alternative perspectives.

Narrated lectures (Watch & Learn)
An interchangeable narrated version of a lesson with synchronized visuals, captions, transcript and interactive checkpoints. Either the lecture or the written lesson completes the lesson.

Interactive labs
8 labs and studios — simulations, calibration tests, a negotiation simulator, design and capital-allocation tools — with one exercise each week.

Assessments
A weekly quiz (162 questions), a weekly applied assignment, a midterm after Week 7 and the executive capstone. A baseline diagnostic in Week 1 is not graded.

3 Weekly Schedule

Lesson titles, concepts, readings, labs, cases, quizzes and assignments for every week, exactly as deployed. Readings are cited by author and year (full entries in Section 4); ◦ marks open access. Week 1 also opens with the ungraded baseline diagnostic.

WEEK 1 How to Think — 7 h

Cognitive Architecture, Judgment & Intellectual Humility

When should you trust your own judgment — and how would you know if it was wrong?

1	Two Kinds of Thinking? Intuition, Deliberation and When to Trust Your Gut	45 min	▶ LECTURE 12 MIN
2	Heuristics, Base Rates and the Search for Confirmation	50 min	▶ LECTURE 10 MIN
3	Overconfidence, Calibration and Keeping Score	50 min	▶ LECTURE 11 MIN
4	Noise, Decision Hygiene and Intellectual Humility	45 min	▶ LECTURE 10 MIN

KEY CONCEPTS Dual-process theories · Conditions for intuitive expertise · Metacognition · Heuristics and biases · Ecological rationality · Base-rate neglect · Bayes' rule and natural frequencies · Confirmation bias · Motivated reasoning · Overconfidence: overestimation, overplacement, overprecision · Calibration · Brier score · First-principles decomposition · Reference-class forecasting · Noise in judgment · Decision hygiene · Intellectual humility · Outcome bias

READINGS Kahneman & Klein (2009); Tversky & Kahneman (1974); Moore & Healy (2008)◦ · Recommended: Mellers et al. (2014)◦; Kahneman et al. (2021); Gigerenzer & Gaissmaier (2011); Evans & Stanovich (2013); Porter et al. (2022)◦

LAB Judgment Lab Behavioral Decision Lab · 35 min

QUIZ 11 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

CASE The Pathway and the Patient 40 min

ASSIGNMENT Decision Journal Template 75 min · 700–1200 words

WEEK 2 Why People Behave the Way They Do — 7 h

Social Psychology, Incentives & Human Motivation

How much of what people do at work is explained by the situations, incentives and social expectations leaders create — and how should that change the way you design them?

1	The Power of the Situation — and What Survived Replication	40 min	▶ LECTURE 11 MIN
2	Why People Try: Self-Determination, Rewards and Crowding Out	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Rewarding A, Hoping for B: Agency, Multitasking and Gaming	45 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Norms, Reciprocity, Status and Safety: The Social Economy of Work	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Situation vs. disposition (attribution) · Conformity and social influence · Replication record of social psychology · Self-determination theory · Intrinsic and extrinsic motivation · Motivation crowding out · Principal–agent problem · Multitask incentive problem · Goodhart's law and metric gaming · Incentive payout shape · Social norms · Reciprocity and conditional cooperation · Fairness and reference points · Social identity and status · Psychological safety

READINGS Gneezy et al. (2011)◦; Kerr (1975) · Recommended: Holmström & Milgrom (1991); Fehr & Gächter (2000)◦; Deci et al. (1999); Frazier et al. (2017); Cerasoli et al. (2014)

LAB Incentive Designer Organizational Design Studio · 30 min

QUIZ 11 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

CASE The Activation Accelerator 35 min

ASSIGNMENT Incentive Misalignment Audit: The Mesa Verde Condors 75 min · 900–1400 words

WEEK 3 How Humans Learn and Develop Expertise

7 h

Learning Science, Skill Acquisition & Deliberate Practice

What actually makes people get better at difficult skills — and how would you know whether a development system is producing learning or only good-looking practice?

1	Learning Is Not Performance: Memory, Retrieval and Desirable Difficulties	38 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Deliberate Practice and Its Critics: What Explains Expertise?	38 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Motor Learning: Practice Schedules, Feedback, Attention — and a Live Debate	42 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Expertise, Transfer and the Coach's Job: Cognitive Load, Myths and Measurement	36 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Learning–performance distinction · Desirable difficulties · Retrieval practice (testing effect) · Spacing (distributed practice) · Interleaving · Deliberate practice · Variance explained and range restriction · Contextual interference · Feedback frequency and the guidance hypothesis · Attentional focus (internal versus external) · Ecological dynamics and the constraints-led approach · Cognitive load and expertise reversal · Transfer of learning (near and far) · Learning-styles matching hypothesis · Measuring learning (retention and transfer tests)

READINGS Soderstrom & Bjork (2015); Macnamara et al. (2016)°; Czyż et al. (2024)° · Recommended: Dunlosky et al. (2013); III & Karpicke (2006); Ericsson & Harwell (2019)°; Macnamara & Maitra (2019)°; McKay et al. (2024)

LAB Learning Architect Organizational Design Studio · 35 min

QUIZ 12 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

CASE The Development Dilemma 30 min

ASSIGNMENT An Evidence-Informed Development Framework 90 min · 1400–2000 words

WEEK 4 How to Know What Is True

7.5 h

Research Literacy, Statistics & Causal Reasoning

When a study, a dashboard or a trusted colleague says something works, how do you decide how much to believe it and what to do about it?

1	Signal, Noise and the Meaning of p	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	The Replication Crisis and the Garden of Forking Paths	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Causal Inference for Executives	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Reading a Study Like a Skeptic	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
5	Evidence Hierarchies, Meta-Analysis and Their Limits	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Regression to the mean · Confidence intervals and sampling variability · p-values: what they are and are not · Statistical power · Bayesian updating · Researcher degrees of freedom · Type M and type S errors · Publication bias and registered reports · Counterfactuals and randomization · Confounding · Selection, collider and survivorship bias · Quasi-experimental designs · Effect size and practical significance · Measurement reliability and validity · External validity · Goodhart's law and metric gaming · Meta-analysis and heterogeneity · Evidence hierarchies

READINGS Wasserstein & Lazar (2016)°; Simmons et al. (2011); Angrist & Pischke (2010)° · Recommended: Gelman & Carlin (2014); Collaboration (2015); Deaton & Cartwright (2018)°; Angrist & Pischke (2014); Ioannidis (2005)°

LAB Evidence Lab Research Critique Lab · 45 min

QUIZ 12 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

CASE The Executive Disagreement 40 min

ASSIGNMENT Critique a Published Study 90 min · 1000–1500 words

WEEK 5 Leadership Is a Social System

7 h

Communication, Trust, Coaching & Executive Presence

If leadership is partly something followers and observers construct, what can a leader actually do to earn trust, develop people and be understood?

1	What Leadership Research Can and Cannot Tell You	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Trust and Psychological Safety: The Conditions for Hearing the Truth	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Coaching, Feedback and Managing Through Others	50 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Executive Communication and the Question of Presence	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Families of leadership theory · Romance of leadership · Critique of transformational leadership research · Leader–member exchange · Trustworthiness: ability, benevolence, integrity · Psychological safety · Listening and questioning · Feedback intervention theory · Coaching effectiveness evidence · Difficult conversations and defensiveness · Delegation and accountability · Answer-first writing (BLUF and the pyramid principle) · Audience analysis · Executive presence as attribution

READINGS Meindl et al. (1985); Mayer et al. (1995); Edmondson (1999) · Recommended: Knippenberg & Sitkin (2013)°; Judge & Piccolo (2004); Kluger & DeNisi (1996); Frazier et al. (2017); Jones et al. (2016)

LAB Leadership Conversation Simulator Executive Communication Studio · 30 min

CASE The Brilliant Analyst 35 min

QUIZ 11 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

ASSIGNMENT One Recommendation, Three Ways 75 min · 1050–1650 words

WEEK 6 Power, Politics & Organizational Influence

6.9 h

The Real Architecture of Organizations

If the organization chart does not show who can make change happen, what does — and how should a leader use that knowledge without corroding the trust the organization runs on?

1	Where Power Comes From: Bases, Dependence and the Chart That Lies	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	The Organization Behind the Chart: Networks, Brokerage and Social Capital	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Coalitions, Legitimacy and the Politics of Change	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Influence Without Authority: Tactics, Issue Selling and the Ethics of Persuasion	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Bases of social power · Power-dependence relations · Resource dependence theory · Formal versus informal authority · Strength of weak ties · Structural holes and brokerage · Informal networks: advice, trust and communication · Organizations as political coalitions · Institutional isomorphism · Co-optation · Organizational legitimacy · Influence tactics · Issue selling · Compliance principles and their replication record · Ethics of influence

READINGS Jr. & Raven (1959)°; Granovetter (1973); DiMaggio & Powell (1983) · Recommended: Yukl & Tracey (1992)°; Dutton & Ashford (1993); Rajkumar et al. (2022); Krackhardt & Hanson (1993); Pfeffer (1992)

LAB Influence Map Organizational Design Studio · 30 min

CASE The Office Nobody Owned 30 min

QUIZ 11 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

ASSIGNMENT Stakeholder Engagement Plan 75 min · 1200–1800 words

WEEK 7 Negotiation & Bargaining

7 h

Interests, Leverage, Conflict & Agreements

When two parties need each other but want different things, what determines whether they reach an agreement, how much value it creates, and who captures that value?

1	The Architecture of a Negotiation: Alternatives, Reservation Values and the Zone of Agreement	37 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Creating and Claiming Value: Integrative Bargaining, Logrolling and Contingent Contracts	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	The Psychology of Bargaining: Anchors, Fairness, Emotion and Context	32 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Negotiating Through Others and Across Borders: Agents, Constituencies, Coalitions and Culture	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
5	Where Hard Bargaining Ends: Deception, Commitments and Difficult Conversations	32 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Best alternative to a negotiated agreement (BATNA) · Reservation value and aspiration · Zone of possible agreement (ZOPA) · Bargaining power · Information asymmetry in bargaining · Integrative versus distributive bargaining · Logrolling and the Pareto frontier · Contingent contracts · The negotiator's dilemma (creating versus claiming value) · First offers as anchors · Fixed-pie perception · Fairness norms and the ultimatum game · Context-dependent gender differences in negotiation outcomes · Principal–agent problem · Cross-cultural negotiation and information exchange · Deception, paltering and negotiation ethics

READINGS Lax & Sebenius (1986); Galinsky & Mussweiler (2001); OpenCourseWare & Rowe (2001)° · Recommended: Fisher & Ury (1981); Thompson & Hastie (1990); Mazei et al. (2015); Adair et al. (2001); Rogers et al. (2017)

LAB Negotiation Chamber Negotiation Simulator · 30 min

CASE The Corridor Agreement 30 min

QUIZ 12 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

ASSIGNMENT Negotiation Strategy Memo 75 min · 1000–1500 words

Midterm — Midterm — Judgment, Evidence and Influence Under Pressure, covering Weeks 1–7 (120 min), taken after this week.

WEEK 8 Building Effective Organizations

7 h

Organizational Design, Incentives & Management Systems

How should an organization divide work, assign decisions and measure performance so that capable people accomplish more together than they could alone?

1	Why Structure Exists: Differentiation, Integration and Information Load	36 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Who Decides? Decision Rights, Knowledge and Coordination	36 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Does Management Matter? Practices, Measures and Their Limits	38 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Routines, Culture and Teams: The Organization Beneath the Chart	34 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Differentiation and integration · Information-processing view of organization design · Contingency theory · Coordinating mechanisms and structural configurations · Span of control and layers · Decision rights · Specific versus general knowledge · Centralization versus decentralization · Conway's law (mirroring hypothesis) · Structured management practices · Multitask incentive problem · Goodhart's law and metric gaming · Management operating rhythm · Organizational routines · Team design conditions

READINGS Galbraith (1974); Jensen & Meckling (1992)°; Bloom et al. (2013)° · Recommended: Mintzberg (1980); Holmström & Milgrom (1991); Colfer & Baldwin (2016)°; Bloom et al. (2020)°; Hackman (2002)

LAB Organization Builder Organizational Design Studio · 42 min

CASE Fourteen Front Doors 33 min

QUIZ 12 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

ASSIGNMENT Design a Department 90 min · 1200–1800 words

Capstone milestone — Read the scenario and exhibits. Build a first chart in the Organization Builder and draft k03 structure, k04 staffing and k05 decision rights.

WEEK 9 Business Strategy & Competitive Advantage

7 h

Thinking Like a General Manager and Chief Strategy Officer

What makes an organization's advantage defensible, and how should scarce resources be committed when rivals adapt and the future is uncertain?

1	What Strategy Is — and What It Is Not	38 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Industry Structure and Value Capture	38 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Resources, Capabilities and the Build-versus-Buy Decision	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Advantage Under Competition and Uncertainty	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Operational effectiveness · Strategic positioning and trade-offs · Fit among activities · Strategy kernel · Opportunity cost · Deliberate and emergent strategy · Five competitive forces · Value creation and added value · Industry versus firm effects on profitability · Resource-based view (VRIN) · Dynamic capabilities · Build versus buy · Erosion of information-based advantage · Real options and staged commitment · Strategic resource allocation

READINGS Porter (1996); Hakes & Sauer (2006)° · Recommended: Rumelt (2011); Porter (2008); Brandenburger & Stuart (1996); Barney (1991); Mintzberg & Waters (1985)

LAB Strategy Table Financial Decision Studio · 45 min

CASE Ferrovane Labs: Deeper, Broader or Underneath? 33 min

QUIZ 12 questions 24 min · mastery 80%

ASSIGNMENT The Strategy Memo 70 min · 1000–1500 words

Capstone milestone — Draft k01 mission and vision, k02 strategic priorities and k08 stakeholder engagement; revise the Week 8 chart so structure follows strategy.

WEEK 10 Finance for Executive Decision-Making

7 h

Understanding Money, Value & Resource Allocation

How should a leader decide where scarce money and talent go when every benefit is uncertain and every yes forecloses something else?

1	Three Statements, One Story: Profit, Cash and Position	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	The Price of Time: NPV, IRR, Payback and the Cost of Capital	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Thinking at the Margin: Cost Behavior, Unit Economics and Capital Rationing	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Valuation Under Uncertainty: Scenarios, Options and the Outside View	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
5	Paying for Wins: The Economics of Talent Spending	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Cash versus accrual profit · Linkage of the three financial statements · Time value of money · Net present value · Internal rate of return · Cost of capital and discount rates · Cost behavior and contribution margin · Marginal analysis · Sunk-cost fallacy · Opportunity cost · Capital rationing · Scenario and sensitivity analysis · Real options and staged commitment · Reference-class forecasting · Marginal revenue product of talent

READINGS Franklin et al. (2019)°; Dahlquist & Knight (2022)°; Hakes & Sauer (2006)° · Recommended: Kahneman & Lovallo (1993); Flyvbjerg (2008); Love & Ahiaga-Dagbui (2018)°; Graham & Harvey (2001); Massey & Thaler (2013)°

LAB Capital Allocation Lab Financial Decision Studio · 35 min

QUIZ 12 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

CASE The Budget Decision 35 min

ASSIGNMENT The Business Case: Financial Justification for an Investment 75 min · 800–1200 words

Capstone milestone – Run the Capital Allocation Lab and draft k06 budget, k07 technology and k12 research and evidence standards.

WEEK 11 Law for Business Leaders

7 h

Legal Reasoning, Contracts & Institutional Constraints

How can a leader who is not a lawyer recognize legal issues early, read agreements as allocations of risk, and know which questions belong to counsel?

1	Legal Reasoning for Non-Lawyers: Prediction, Rules and Proof	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Contracts: Formation, Meaning, Risk and Remedies	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Employment Agreements, Restrictive Covenants and Who Owns the Work	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Agency, Fiduciary Duty and Institutional Constraints	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
5	Working With Counsel: Timing, Privilege and Legal Risk	30 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Issue spotting and IRAC · Rules versus standards · Precedent and jurisdiction · Burden of proof · Contract formation and consideration · Contract interpretation and conditions · Representations, warranties and risk allocation · Contract remedies and damages · At-will employment · Restrictive covenants (non-competes and non-solicitation) · Invention assignment and confidentiality · Agency and authority · Fiduciary duties of care and loyalty · Business judgment rule · Institutional constraints (regulation, labor law, league rules) · Attorney-client privilege and work product · Legal risk management and working with counsel

READINGS Valbrune & Assis (2019)°; Jr. (1897)°; Starr et al. (2021)° · Recommended: Kaplow (1992)°; Macaulay (1963); Marx et al. (2009)°; Delaware (1985)°; States (1981)°

LAB Contract Lab Contract Issue-Spotting Lab · 35 min

QUIZ 12 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

CASE The Contract Problem 35 min

ASSIGNMENT Issue-Spotting Memorandum: A Professional Services Agreement 70 min · 900–1300 words

Capstone milestone – Draft k09 legal and ethical considerations (issues for counsel, not conclusions) and k10 organizational communication.

WEEK 12 Strategy into Execution

7 h

Change Management, Operations & Organizational Implementation

Why do sound strategies so often fail to change what an organization actually does, and how should a leader sequence change so that it takes hold?

1	Why Execution Fails: The Gap Between Choosing and Doing	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Change Models and the Evidence Behind Them	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Operations: Flow, Bottlenecks, Variability and Standard Work	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Implementation Across Cultures and Institutions	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Strategy–execution gap · Resource allocation as realized strategy · Cross-functional coordination · Capability trap · The 70 per cent change-failure claim · Practitioner change models (Kotter, three-step) · Readiness for change (commitment and efficacy) · Resistance as information · Little's law · Bottlenecks and utilization · Standard work as experiment · Leading and lagging indicators · Cultural dimensions and their limits · Institutional distance and internalization · Fidelity and adaptation (core and periphery)

READINGS Sull et al. (2015); Hughes (2011); Damschroder et al. (2009)° · Recommended: Repenning & Sterman (2001)°; Kotter (1995); Weiner (2009)°; Kostova (1999); Spear & Bowen (1999)

LAB Change Simulator Organizational Design Studio · 35 min

QUIZ 11 questions 25 min · mastery 80%

CASE The International Initiative 35 min

ASSIGNMENT A 90-Day Implementation Roadmap 75 min · 1500–2500 words

Capstone milestone – Draft k11 indicators, k13 change management and k14 the first 90 days; assemble the roadmap deliverable.

WEEK 13 Ethics, Governance and Decisions Under Uncertainty

7.3 h

Executive Responsibility

What do leaders owe the people their decisions affect, and how should they decide responsibly when their own judgment is biased and the consequences cannot be known?

1	What Executives Owe: Ethical Frameworks, Conflicts of Interest and the Purpose of the Organization	45 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Good People, Bad Calls: Bounded Ethicality, Ethical Fading and the Slippery Slope	45 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Governance, Accountability and Responsible AI	50 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	Deciding When You Cannot Know: Deep Uncertainty, Robustness and Irreversibility	50 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Ethical frameworks · Shareholder primacy · Stakeholder theory · Conflict of interest · Bounded ethicality · Ethical fading · Slippery-slope effect · Principal–agent problem · Whistleblowing and speak-up channels · Algorithmic bias and proxy targets · AI risk management · Risk versus Knightian uncertainty · Robust and adaptive decision making · Irreversibility and the value of flexibility · Premortem

READINGS Tenbrunsel & Messick (2004); Obermeyer et al. (2019); Marchau et al. (2019)° · Recommended: Friedman (1970); Bebchuk & Tallarita (2020)°; Kristal et al. (2020)°; Technology (2023)°; Dyck et al. (2010)

LAB Executive Dilemma Behavioral Decision Lab · 40 min

QUIZ 11 questions 30 min · mastery 80%

CASE The House Fund 40 min

ASSIGNMENT Executive decision memo on an ethical or governance dilemma 75 min · 900–1300 words

Capstone milestone – Run a premortem; draft k15 roadmap and k16 risk register and scenarios; revisit k09 with Week 13's ethics and governance lens; assemble the strategic memo and budget model.

WEEK 14 The Executive Capstone

7 h

Integrating Human Behavior, Strategy, Law & Leadership

How does a leader combine behavior, evidence, strategy, money, law and ethics into one decision that can be built, presented, defended under questioning and learned from afterward?

1	Integrative Judgment: One Decision, Six Lenses	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
2	Building a Function from Zero: Newness, Legitimacy and the First Ninety Days	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
3	Presenting and Defending Decisions to Senior Leaders and Boards	40 min	LECTURE COMING SOON
4	The Leader's Learning Agenda: Outcomes, Process and After-Action Reviews	35 min	LECTURE COMING SOON

KEY CONCEPTS Integrative thinking · Binding constraint · Decision hygiene · Checklists and implementation context · Liability of newness · Liability of adolescence · Organizational legitimacy · Early wins · Answer-first writing (BLUF and the pyramid principle) · Premortem · Steelmanning · Question dodging · Outcome bias · After-action review · Personal learning agenda

READINGS Klein (2007); Tannenbaum & Cerasoli (2013)°; Baron & Hershey (1988) · Recommended: Martin (2007); Stinchcombe (1965); Watkins (2013); Urbach & al. (2014); Rogers & Norton (2011)°

LAB Decision Presentation Studio Executive Communication Studio · 45 min

CASE The Hollis Creek Decision 35 min

QUIZ 12 questions 30 min · mastery 80%

ASSIGNMENT Board Question Rehearsal 70 min · 800–1300 words

Capstone milestone – Draft k17 presentation in the Communication Studio and k18 written defense; write the executive summary and reflection; self-assess each deliverable against its rubric and log key decisions in the Decision Journal.

4 Reading List

39 required and 68 recommended readings, drawn from a library of 197 sources. **42** are open access or free with registration; **65** are restricted (paywalled, library access or purchase) — use a library, an author copy where the library notes one, or the APERTURE summary. Every title links to its publisher, DOI or official page.

REQUIRED

Adam D. Galinsky & Thomas Mussweiler (2001). First offers as anchors: The role of perspective-taking and negotiator focus. PAYWALLED Wk 7

Amos Tversky & Daniel Kahneman (1974). Judgment under Uncertainty: Heuristics and Biases. PAYWALLED Wk 1

Amy Edmondson (1999). Psychological Safety and Learning Behavior in Work Teams. PAYWALLED Wk 5

Ann E. Tenbrunsel & David M. Messick (2004). Ethical Fading: The Role of Self-Deception in Unethical Behavior. PAYWALLED Wk 13

Brooke N. Macnamara, David Moreau & David Z. Hambrick (2016). The Relationship Between Deliberate Practice and Performance in Sports: A Meta-Analysis. OPEN ACCESS Wk 3

Daniel Kahneman & Gary Klein (2009). Conditions for Intuitive Expertise: A Failure to Disagree. PAYWALLED Wk 1

David A. Lax & James K. Sebenius (1986). The Manager as Negotiator: Bargaining for Cooperation and Competitive Gain. PURCHASE Wk 7

Don A. Moore & Paul J. Healy (2008). The Trouble with Overconfidence. OPEN ACCESS Wk 1

Donald Sull, Rebecca Homkes & Charles Sull (2015). Why Strategy Execution Unravels—and What to Do About It. PAYWALLED Wk 12

Evan P. Starr, J. J. Prescott & Norman D. Bishara (2021). Noncompete Agreements in the US Labor Force. OPEN ACCESS Wk 11

Gary Klein (2007). Performing a Project Premortem. PAYWALLED Wk 14

Jahn K. Hakes & Raymond D. Sauer (2006). An Economic Evaluation of the Moneyball Hypothesis. OPEN ACCESS Wk 9, 10

James R. Meindl, Sanford B. Ehrlich & Janet M. Dukerich (1985). The Romance of Leadership. LIBRARY ACCESS Wk 5

Jay R. Galbraith (1974). Organization Design: An Information Processing View. PAYWALLED Wk 8

John R. P. French Jr. & Bertram Raven (1959). The Bases of Social Power. OPEN ACCESS Wk 6

Jonathan Baron & John C. Hershey (1988). Outcome Bias in Decision Evaluation. LIBRARY ACCESS Wk 14

Joseph P. Simmons, Leif D. Nelson & Uri Simonsohn (2011). False-Positive Psychology: Undisclosed Flexibility in Data Collection and Analysis Allows Presenting Anything as Significant. PAYWALLED Wk 4

Joshua D. Angrist & Jörn-Steffen Pischke (2010). The Credibility Revolution in Empirical Economics: How Better Research Design Is Taking the Con out of Econometrics. OPEN ACCESS Wk 4

Julie Dahlquist & Rainford Knight (2022). Principles of Finance. OPEN ACCESS Wk 10

Laura J. Damschroder et al. (2009). Fostering Implementation of Health Services Research Findings into Practice: A Consolidated Framework for Advancing Implementation Science. OPEN ACCESS Wk 12

Mark Hughes (2011). Do 70 Per Cent of All Organizational Change Initiatives Really Fail?. PAYWALLED Wk 12

Mark S. Granovetter (1973). The Strength of Weak Ties. PAYWALLED Wk 6

Michael C. Jensen & William H. Meckling (1992). Specific and General Knowledge, and Organizational Structure. OPEN ACCESS Wk 8

Michael E. Porter (1996). What Is Strategy?. PAYWALLED Wk 9

Mirande Valbrune & Renee De Assis (2019). Business Law I Essentials. OPEN ACCESS Wk 11

MIT OpenCourseWare & Mary Rowe (2001). Negotiation and Conflict Management (15.667, Spring 2001). OPEN ACCESS Wk 7

Mitchell Franklin, Patty Graybeal & Dixon Cooper (2019). Principles of Accounting, Volume 1: Financial Accounting. OPEN ACCESS Wk 10

Nicholas Bloom et al. (2013). Does Management Matter? Evidence from India. OPEN ACCESS Wk 8

Nicholas C. Soderstrom & Robert A. Bjork (2015). Learning Versus Performance: An Integrative Review. PAYWALLED Wk 3

Oliver Wendell Holmes Jr. (1897). The Path of the Law. OPEN ACCESS Wk 11

Paul J. DiMaggio & Walter W. Powell (1983). The Iron Cage Revisited: Institutional Isomorphism and Collective Rationality in Organizational Fields. PAYWALLED Wk 6

Roger C. Mayer, James H. Davis & F. David Schoorman (1995). An Integrative Model of Organizational Trust. LIBRARY ACCESS Wk 5

Ronald L. Wasserstein & Nicole A. Lazar (2016). The ASA's Statement on p-Values: Context, Process, and Purpose. OPEN ACCESS Wk 4

Scott I. Tannenbaum & Christopher P. Cerasoli (2013). Do Team and Individual Debriefs Enhance Performance? A Meta-Analysis. OPEN ACCESS Wk 14

Stanisław H. Czyż, Aleksandra M. Wójcik & Petra Solarská (2024). The Effect of Contextual Interference on Transfer in Motor Learning: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis. OPEN ACCESS Wk 3

Steven Kerr (1975). On the Folly of Rewarding A, While Hoping for B. PAYWALLED Wk 2

Uri Gneezy, Stephan Meier & Pedro Rey-Biel (2011). When and Why Incentives (Don't) Work to Modify Behavior. OPEN ACCESS Wk 2

Vincent A. W. J. Marchau et al. (2019). Decision Making under Deep Uncertainty: From Theory to Practice. OPEN ACCESS Wk 13

Ziad Obermeyer et al. (2019). Dissecting Racial Bias in an Algorithm Used to Manage the Health of Populations. PAYWALLED Wk 13

RECOMMENDED

Adam M. Brandenburger & Harborne W. Stuart (1996). Value-based Business Strategy. PAYWALLED Wk 9

Alexander Dyck, Adair Morse & Luigi Zingales (2010). Who Blows the Whistle on Corporate Fraud?. PAYWALLED Wk 13

Andrew Gelman & John Carlin (2014). Beyond Power Calculations: Assessing Type S (Sign) and Type M (Magnitude) Errors. PAYWALLED Wk 4

Angus Deaton & Nancy Cartwright (2018). Understanding and misunderstanding randomized controlled trials. OPEN ACCESS Wk 4

Ariella S. Kristal et al. (2020). Signing at the Beginning versus at the End Does Not Decrease Dishonesty. OPEN ACCESS Wk 13

Arthur L. Stinchcombe (1965). Social Structure and Organizations. LIBRARY ACCESS Wk 14

Avraham N. Kluger & Angelo DeNisi (1996). The Effects of Feedback Interventions on Performance: A Historical Review, a Meta-Analysis, and a Preliminary Feedback Intervention Theory. PAYWALLED Wk 5

Barbara Mellers et al. (2014). Psychological Strategies for Winning a Geopolitical Forecasting Tournament. OPEN ACCESS Wk 1

Bengt Holmström & Paul Milgrom (1991). Multitask Principal–Agent Analyses: Incentive Contracts, Asset Ownership, and Job Design. PAYWALLED Wk 2, 8

Bent Flyvbjerg (2008). Curbing Optimism Bias and Strategic Misrepresentation in Planning: Reference Class Forecasting in Practice. PAYWALLED Wk 10

Brooke N. Macnamara & Megha Maitra (2019). The Role of Deliberate Practice in Expert Performance: Revisiting Ericsson, Krampe & Tesch-Römer (1993). OPEN ACCESS Wk 3

Bryan J. Weiner (2009). A Theory of Organizational Readiness for Change. OPEN ACCESS Wk 12

Cade Massey & Richard H. Thaler (2013). The Loser's Curse: Decision Making and Market Efficiency in the National Football League Draft. OPEN ACCESS Wk 10

Christopher P. Cerasoli, Jessica M. Nicklin & Michael T. Ford (2014). Intrinsic Motivation and Extrinsic Incentives Jointly Predict Performance: A 40-Year Meta-Analysis. PAYWALLED Wk 2

Daan van Knippenberg & Sim B. Sitkin (2013). A Critical Assessment of Charismatic–Transformational Leadership Research: Back to the Drawing Board?. OPEN ACCESS Wk 5

Daniel Kahneman & Dan Lovallo (1993). Timid Choices and Bold Forecasts: A Cognitive Perspective on Risk Taking. PAYWALLED Wk 10

Daniel Kahneman, Olivier Sibony & Cass R. Sunstein (2021). Noise: A Flaw in Human Judgment. PURCHASE Wk 1

David Krackhardt & Jeffrey R. Hanson (1993). Informal Networks: The Company Behind the Chart. PAYWALLED Wk 6

David R. Urbach & et al. (2014). Introduction of Surgical Safety Checklists in Ontario, Canada. PAYWALLED Wk 14

Edward L. Deci, Richard Koestner & Richard M. Ryan (1999). A Meta-Analytic Review of Experiments Examining the Effects of Extrinsic Rewards on Intrinsic Motivation. PAYWALLED Wk 2

Ernst Fehr & Simon Gächter (2000). Fairness and Retaliation: The Economics of Reciprocity. OPEN ACCESS Wk 2

Gary Yukl & J. Bruce Tracey (1992). Consequences of Influence Tactics Used with Subordinates, Peers, and the Boss. OPEN ACCESS Wk 6

Gerd Gigerenzer & Wolfgang Gaissmaier (2011). Heuristic Decision Making. PAYWALLED Wk 1

Henry L. Roediger III & Jeffrey D. Karpicke (2006). Test-Enhanced Learning: Taking Memory Tests Improves Long-Term Retention. PAYWALLED Wk 3

Henry Mintzberg (1980). Structure in 5's: A Synthesis of the Research on Organization Design. LIBRARY ACCESS Wk 8

Henry Mintzberg & James A. Waters (1985). Of Strategies, Deliberate and Emergent. PAYWALLED Wk 9

J. Richard Hackman (2002). Leading Teams: Setting the Stage for Great Performances. PURCHASE Wk 8

Jane E. Dutton & Susan J. Ashford (1993). Selling Issues to Top Management. PAYWALLED Wk 6

Jay Barney (1991). Firm Resources and Sustained Competitive Advantage. PAYWALLED Wk 9

Jeffrey Pfeffer (1992). Managing with Power: Politics and Influence in Organizations. PURCHASE Wk 6

Jens Mazei et al. (2015). A meta-analysis on gender differences in negotiation outcomes and their moderators. PAYWALLED Wk 7

John Dunlosky et al. (2013). Improving Students' Learning With Effective Learning Techniques: Promising Directions From Cognitive and Educational Psychology. LIBRARY ACCESS Wk 3

John P. A. Ioannidis (2005). Why Most Published Research Findings Are False. OPEN ACCESS Wk 4

John P. Kotter (1995). Leading Change: Why Transformation Efforts Fail. PAYWALLED Wk 12

John R. Graham & Campbell R. Harvey (2001). The Theory and Practice of Corporate Finance: Evidence from the Field. PAYWALLED Wk 10

Jonathan St. B. T. Evans & Keith E. Stanovich (2013). Dual-Process Theories of Higher Cognition: Advancing the Debate. PAYWALLED Wk 1

Joshua D. Angrist & Jörn-Steffen Pischke (2014). Mastering 'Metrics: The Path from Cause to Effect. PURCHASE Wk 4

K. Anders Ericsson & Kyle W. Harwell (2019). Deliberate Practice and Proposed Limits on the Effects of Practice on the Acquisition of Expert Performance. OPEN ACCESS Wk 3

Karthik Rajkumar et al. (2022). A Causal Test of the Strength of Weak Ties. PAYWALLED Wk 6

Leigh Thompson & Reid Hastie (1990). Social perception in negotiation. PAYWALLED Wk 7

Louis Kaplow (1992). Rules Versus Standards: An Economic Analysis. OPEN ACCESS Wk 11

Lucian A. Bebchuk & Roberto Tallarita (2020). The Illusory Promise of Stakeholder Governance. OPEN ACCESS Wk 13

Lyra J. Colfer & Carliss Y. Baldwin (2016). The Mirroring Hypothesis: Theory, Evidence, and Exceptions. OPEN ACCESS Wk 8

M. Lance Frazier et al. (2017). Psychological Safety: A Meta-Analytic Review and Extension. PAYWALLED Wk 2, 5

Matt Marx, Deborah Strumsky & Lee Fleming (2009). Mobility, Skills, and the Michigan Non-Compete Experiment. OPEN ACCESS Wk 11

McKay et al. (2024). Reporting Bias, Not External Focus: A Robust Bayesian Meta-Analysis and Systematic Review of the External Focus of Attention Literature. PAYWALLED Wk 3

Michael D. Watkins (2013). The First 90 Days: Proven Strategies for Getting Up to Speed Faster and Smarter. PURCHASE Wk 14

Michael E. Porter (2008). The Five Competitive Forces That Shape Strategy. PAYWALLED Wk 9

Milton Friedman (1970). The Social Responsibility of Business Is to Increase Its Profits. PAYWALLED Wk 13

National Institute of Standards and Technology (2023). Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Framework (AI RMF 1.0). OPEN ACCESS Wk 13

Nelson P. Repenning & John D. Sterman (2001). Nobody Ever Gets Credit for Fixing Problems that Never Happened: Creating and Sustaining Process Improvement. OPEN ACCESS Wk 12

Nicholas Bloom et al. (2020). Do Management Interventions Last? Evidence from India. OPEN ACCESS Wk 8

Open Science Collaboration (2015). Estimating the reproducibility of psychological science. PAYWALLED Wk 4

Peter E. D. Love & Dominic Ahiaga-Dagbui (2018). Debunking Fake News in a Post-Truth Era: The Plausible Untruths of Cost Underestimation in Transport Infrastructure Projects. OPEN ACCESS Wk 10

Rebecca J. Jones, Stephen A. Woods & Yves R. F. Guillaume (2016). The Effectiveness of Workplace Coaching: A Meta-Analysis of Learning and Performance Outcomes from Coaching. PAYWALLED Wk 5

Richard P. Rumelt (2011). Good Strategy Bad Strategy: The Difference and Why It Matters. PURCHASE Wk 9

Roger Fisher & William Ury (1981). Getting to Yes: Negotiating Agreement Without Giving In. PURCHASE Wk 7

Roger L. Martin (2007). The Opposable Mind: How Successful Leaders Win Through Integrative Thinking. PURCHASE Wk 14

Steven Spear & H. Kent Bowen (1999). Decoding the DNA of the Toyota Production System. PAYWALLED Wk 12

Stewart Macaulay (1963). Non-Contractual Relations in Business: A Preliminary Study. LIBRARY ACCESS Wk 11

Supreme Court of Delaware (1985). Smith v. Van Gorkom, 488 A.2d 858. OPEN ACCESS Wk 11

Supreme Court of the United States (1981). Upjohn Co. v. United States, 449 U.S. 383. OPEN ACCESS Wk 11

Tatiana Kostova (1999). Transnational Transfer of Strategic Organizational Practices: A Contextual Perspective. PAYWALLED Wk 12

Tenelle Porter et al. (2022). Predictors and Consequences of Intellectual Humility. OPEN ACCESS Wk 1

Timothy A. Judge & Ronald F. Piccolo (2004). Transformational and Transactional Leadership: A Meta-Analytic Test of Their Relative Validity. PAYWALLED Wk 5

Todd Rogers & Michael I. Norton (2011). The Artful Dodger: Answering the Wrong Question the Right Way. OPEN ACCESS Wk 14

Todd Rogers et al. (2017). Artful paltering: The risks and rewards of using truthful statements to mislead others. PAYWALLED Wk 7

Wendi L. Adair, Tetsushi Okumura & Jeanne M. Brett (2001). Negotiation behavior when cultures collide: The United States and Japan. PAYWALLED Wk 7

5 Assessments & Grading

COMPONENT	WEIGHT	HOW IT IS SCORED IN V1
Weekly quizzes	30%	Best attempt per week, averaged over the weeks taken. 14 quizzes. Auto-graded items plus your self-assessed short responses (labelled).
Applied assignments	25%	14 assignments, each self-assessed against its weighted rubric (four levels: Exemplary, Proficient, Developing, Beginning). Automated checks cover format only.
Midterm	20%	Best attempt. Auto-graded items plus self-assessed short responses.
Executive capstone	25%	7 deliverables, each self-assessed against its rubric; the component is their average.

Mastery. Mastery is 80% of the auto-graded points on each weekly quiz and on the midterm. Below it, APERTURE lists the lessons and concepts behind your misses and offers a reassessment drawn from reserve questions plus the items you missed. **Standing.** Your current standing is the weighted average of the components you have completed, using the published weights. It is shown on the Progress page.

Weekly quizzes
14 quizzes, 162 questions in all (56 more in reserve for reassessment), in nine formats including scenarios, ranking, numeric estimates and short answers.

Applied assignments
One a week, written as professional work – from a decision-journal template in Week 1 to a 90-day roadmap in Week 12 – with a template, a weighted rubric and format checks.

Midterm
Midterm – Judgment, Evidence and Influence Under Pressure. An original cumulative case, *Velmont Athletic and the Decision Machine*, then 20 questions (8 in reserve); about 2 hours; covers Weeks 1–7.

Executive capstone
7 deliverables built from 18 components over Weeks 8–14 (Section 7).

SCORING RULES

- Single-answer items (multiple choice, scenario, flaw, research, decision): all or nothing.
- Multi-select and issue-spotting: partial credit = max(0, (correct − wrong picks) / correct options).
- Ranking: 1 − footrule distance / maximum distance.
- Numeric: correct within the stated tolerance.
- Short answer: never auto-graded; self-assessed against the rubric and model answer.

FORMATIVE WORK (NOT GRADED)

Baseline diagnostic · Lesson comprehension checks · Lecture checkpoints · Lab exercises · Case analyses · Weekly reflections · Review cards. The baseline diagnostic (32 questions, 45 min) sets your starting point and can adapt the course's suggestions.

Each assignment's weighted rubric is shown with the assignment and in the in-app Syllabus page.

6 Lecture Format

Every lesson can be learned two ways. **Watch Lecture** is a narrated, interactive version (Watch & Learn): one narration track drives synchronized visuals, captions and a transcript, and pauses at interactive checkpoints – predict a number,

decide a case, explore a model, or reflect. **Read Lesson** is the full written lesson. Both cover the same objectives and sources and lead to the same comprehension check; finishing either completes the lesson.

Player
Play, pause and ±10-second skips; speed from 0.75× to 2×; chapters; captions; a synchronized transcript (click any line to jump); audio-only mode for listening on the move; downloadable transcript and captions; keyboard shortcuts; works on desktop and phone.

Progress
Position, furthest point, checkpoint answers and time are saved; the lecture resumes where you stopped and the dashboard offers “Resume lecture”. Checkpoints are formative and never graded.

RELEASE STATUS

The first 5 narrated lectures are released now, in Voice C, the official APERTURE narration voice. The remaining 55 are scripted and will be released in order; until then their lessons show “Narrated Lecture — Coming Soon” and open in the written view. Only the narrated version is pending — every lesson is complete and available.

LESSON	TITLE	LECTURE	CHECKPOINTS
W1·L1	Two Kinds of Thinking? Intuition, Deliberation and When to Trust Your Gut	12 min	3
W1·L2	Heuristics, Base Rates and the Search for Confirmation	10 min	5
W1·L3	Overconfidence, Calibration and Keeping Score	11 min	3
W1·L4	Noise, Decision Hygiene and Intellectual Humility	10 min	3
W2·L1	The Power of the Situation — and What Survived Replication	11 min	4

7 Capstone Project

The Executive Capstone: Building an Advance and Strategic Coordination Department

A fictional mid-market club in the fictional 30-club Meridian League. Payroll sits in the league's lower-middle third; the club finished 79–83 last season, four games out of the final postseason place. It operates a minor-league system of five affiliates and an international academy, and has just created a Department of Advance and Strategic Coordination. All people, organizations, figures and events are invented.

All people, organizations, leagues and data in this capstone are fictional and synthetic. The Port Calder Lamplighters and the Meridian League are invented; nothing describes or is modeled on any real club's internal structure. Legal points are educational and general — not legal advice.

You lead a new department and must design, fund and launch it. The capstone runs from Week 8 to Week 14: 18 components, each drafted in the week that teaches its tools, are assembled into 7 deliverables and defended against 12 hard questions. You work from 6 exhibits with three tools: Organization Builder (Organizational Design Studio); Capital Allocation Lab (Financial Decision Studio); Decision Presentation Studio (Executive Communication Studio).

DELIVERABLES AND EVALUATION CRITERIA

DELIVERABLE	LENGTH	RUBRIC CRITERIA (WEIGHT)
Strategic memorandum	3,000–4,500 words	Diagnosis and strategic coherence (25); Use of evidence (20); Stakeholder, legal and ethical judgment (20); Trade-offs and risks (20); Executive writing (15)
Executive summary	400–600 words	Recommendation first (30); Selection of content (25); Honesty about uncertainty (25); Concision and clarity (20)
Organizational chart	900–1,500 words	Fit between structure and work (25); Budget and staffing realism (20); Decision rights (25); Interfaces with other departments (15); Explanation of checks (15)
Budget model	500–900 words	Completeness and accuracy (25); Investment reasoning (25); Sensitivity and assumptions (25); Non-financial considerations (25)
Implementation roadmap	1,500–2,500 words	Sequencing and dependencies (25); Change approach (20); Indicators (25); Gates and reversibility (20); Usability (10)
Decision presentation	1,800–2,900 words	Answer first and decisions requested (25); Economy (20); Quality of the defense (30); Calibration (15); Audience fit (10)
Reflection on strengths and areas for development	800–1,200 words	Evidence-anchored self-assessment (30); Candor about development areas (25); Integration across schools (20); Forward plan (25)

Each deliverable is self-assessed against its four-level rubric; the capstone's 25% is the average of the deliverables assessed.

MILESTONES

Week 8	Read the scenario and exhibits. Build a first chart in the Organization Builder and draft k03 structure, k04 staffing and k05 decision rights.
Week 9	Draft k01 mission and vision, k02 strategic priorities and k08 stakeholder engagement; revise the Week 8 chart so structure follows strategy.
Week 10	Run the Capital Allocation Lab and draft k06 budget, k07 technology and k12 research and evidence standards.
Week 11	Draft k09 legal and ethical considerations (issues for counsel, not conclusions) and k10 organizational communication.
Week 12	Draft k11 indicators, k13 change management and k14 the first 90 days; assemble the roadmap deliverable.
Week 13	Run a premortem; draft k15 roadmap and k16 risk register and scenarios; revisit k09 with Week 13's ethics and governance lens; assemble the strategic memo and budget model.

Week 14	Draft k17 presentation in the Communication Studio and k18 written defense; write the executive summary and reflection; self-assess each deliverable against its rubric and log key decisions in the Decision Journal.

8 Learning Resources

Research library
197 sources (71 open access, 111 restricted), each with a summary, research design, evidence level, strengths, limitations, replication status and the lessons that use it.

Notebook
Highlights and notes made in any lesson, bookmarks, weekly reflections, assignment drafts and saved concepts, all searchable.

Labs and simulations
8 labs, including the Strategic Decision Journal you begin in Week 1 and use all semester.

Review and glossary
220 spaced-repetition review cards and a 259-term glossary.

Progress and insights
Lessons, quizzes, assignments and lectures completed, the weighted standing, time on task and concept-level evidence of what to review.

Study help prompts
Each lesson can generate a study prompt (explain, quiz me, apply, critique) to copy into ChatGPT. Nothing is sent unless you copy it or open ChatGPT yourself.

LABS

- **Behavioral Decision Lab** – Probability estimates, calibration, hypothetical outcomes and decisions under competing obligations.
- **Negotiation Simulator** – Multi-round, multi-issue bargaining against a rule-based counterpart with explicit assumptions.
- **Organizational Design Studio** – Design incentives, practice systems, structures, stakeholder strategies and change sequences.
- **Research Critique Lab** – Simulate how sample size, selection, measurement and multiple testing distort what studies report.
- **Financial Decision Studio** – Budgets, discounted cash flows, capital rationing and strategic resource allocation.
- **Executive Communication Studio** – Difficult conversations, recommendations in three lengths, and decision presentations.
- **Contract Issue-Spotting Lab** – Read fictional agreements clause by clause and flag commercial and legal risk.
- **Strategic Decision Journal** – Structured records of consequential decisions, forecasts and later reviews.

9 Academic Integrity & Source Standards

APERTURE separates what research shows from what APERTURE says. Every prose passage in the lessons carries one of six labels, shown beside it and counted in each lesson's source panel.

LABEL	MEANING	PASSAGES
Established research	A well-supported finding or theory. Always cites at least one library record.	261
Contested finding	A finding that failed to replicate or is disputed. Both sides are stated and cited.	34
APERTURE explanation	Original APERTURE instruction: explanation, synthesis or a teaching device. It is not presented as research.	884
Illustrative example	A real example (sourced) or a clearly hypothetical one. Cases, organizations and data in exercises are fictional and say so.	151
Professional application	How the idea transfers to executive work, player development or baseball operations.	70
Speculative hypothesis	APERTURE's own conjecture, labelled so it is never mistaken for evidence.	14

AI-ASSISTED MATERIALS

- APERTURE's original explanations, cases, quiz items, lecture scripts and this syllabus were drafted with AI assistance and are labelled as APERTURE material, not research. Research claims are tied to library records whose bibliographic details were checked; the library records how each was verified.
- Lecture narration is synthesized speech (the open Kokoro-82M voice model). It reads APERTURE's scripts; it is not a recording of a person.
- The optional ChatGPT study prompts are a study aid. Graded written work — assignments, short answers and capstone deliverables — should be your own; you assess it yourself against the rubric.

FICTION AND LEGAL MATERIAL

All people, organizations and data in cases, exercises, the midterm and the capstone are fictional and say so. Legal material is educational and general, never legal advice.

YOUR OWN WORK

Self-assessment only works if it is honest: rate your work against the rubric as a demanding reviewer would, and keep the Decision Journal contemporaneous. Cite the sources you use in assignments the way the lessons do.

10 Learning Outcomes

By the end of Semester I you should be able to:

1. **Calibrated judgment.** Judge when intuition can be trusted, correct for base rates and confirmation, and state confidence that matches your accuracy — measured, not assumed, in the Judgment Lab and the Decision Journal. Weeks 1, 4, 13.
2. **Behavioral diagnosis.** Explain behavior through situations, incentives, norms and motivation, and design incentives and learning environments that do not crowd out the behavior they are meant to produce. Weeks 2, 3.
3. **Evidence and causal reasoning.** Read research critically: distinguish correlation from causation, recognize study-design limits, and weigh contested findings before acting on them. Weeks 3, 4, 13.

4. **Leadership and influence.** Lead as a participant in a social system: build trust, communicate one recommendation to different audiences, and map power and stakeholders before seeking support. Weeks 5, 6.
5. **Negotiation.** Prepare and conduct negotiations from interests, alternatives and reservation values, and turn the preparation into a written strategy. Weeks 7.
6. **Organizational and strategic design.** Design structures, decision rights and strategies that fit the work, and translate strategy into a sequenced, measurable implementation plan. Weeks 8, 9, 12.
7. **Financial decision-making.** Build and defend a business case: allocate capital under constraints, test sensitivity to assumptions, and state the non-financial considerations. Weeks 10.
8. **Legal and ethical reasoning.** Spot contractual and legal issues for counsel without overstepping into legal advice, and reason through ethical and governance dilemmas under uncertainty. Weeks 11, 13.
9. **Executive communication and integration.** Integrate every school of the semester in one executive recommendation — memo, model, roadmap and presentation — and defend it under hard questions. Weeks 5, 14.

A Appendix: Not Specified in the Curriculum

The following are not defined in the deployed curriculum. They are listed rather than invented.

Calendar dates
Semester I is self-paced. The curriculum has no start date, due dates or session times, so the schedule is given by week number only.

Instructor and office hours
APERTURE is self-directed. There is no instructor, teaching staff, office hours or discussion section.

Letter grades and passing mark
V1 reports a weighted percentage standing over completed components. It defines no letter-grade scale, passing mark, honors or failing grade, and awards no credit.

Attempt limits and late policy
V1 sets no limit on quiz or midterm attempts, no deadlines and no late penalties. A reassessment becomes available after an attempt below mastery.

Course-level statements
The curriculum stores week-level objectives, not a course description, philosophy or semester outcomes. Those sections of this syllabus are composed from the weekly objectives and the application's own features.

Weekly workload
The stated workload is 5–7 hours a week. The planned hours of Week 4 (7.45 h) and Week 13 (7.3 h) are slightly above 7.

Source links
Library metadata was verified through search results; 197 of 197 links are marked "link untested" until opened in a browser, and 27 records are only partially confirmed.

Narrated lectures
5 of 60 narrated lectures are released. The other 55 are scripted and marked Coming Soon; every lesson is complete in its written form.